



Improving Evolutionary Van Gogh

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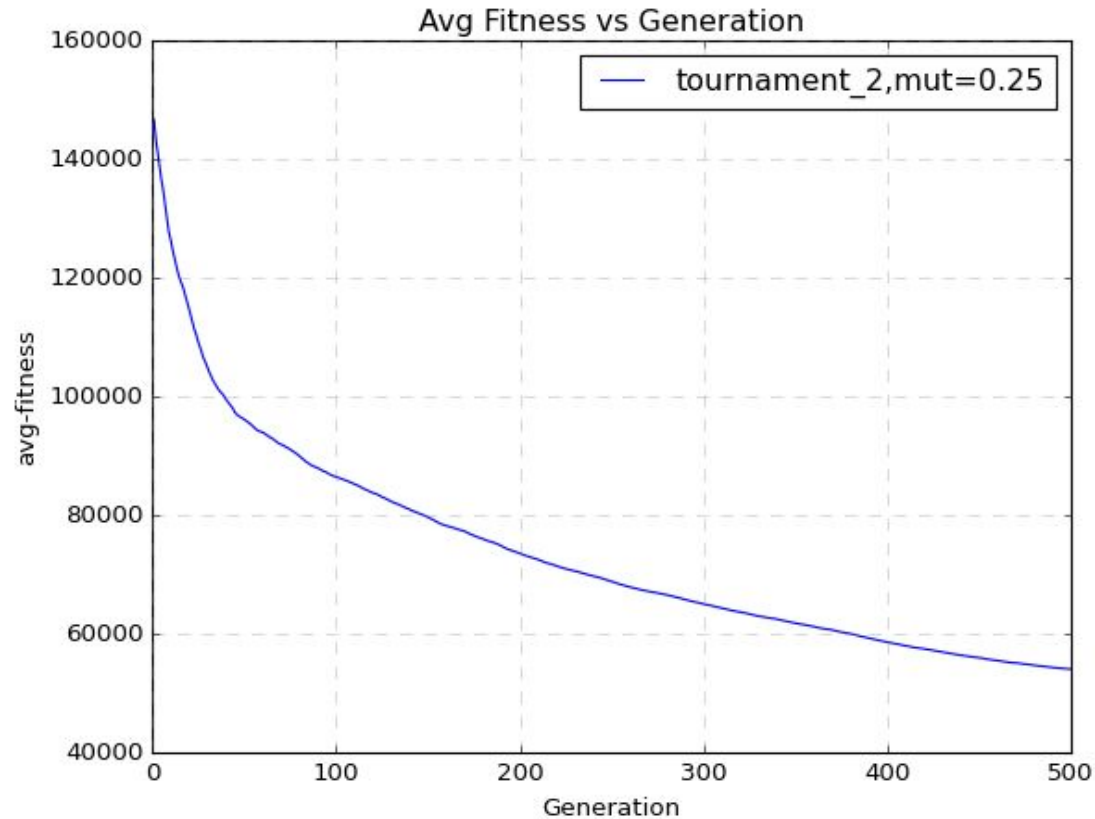
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Group 16

Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness

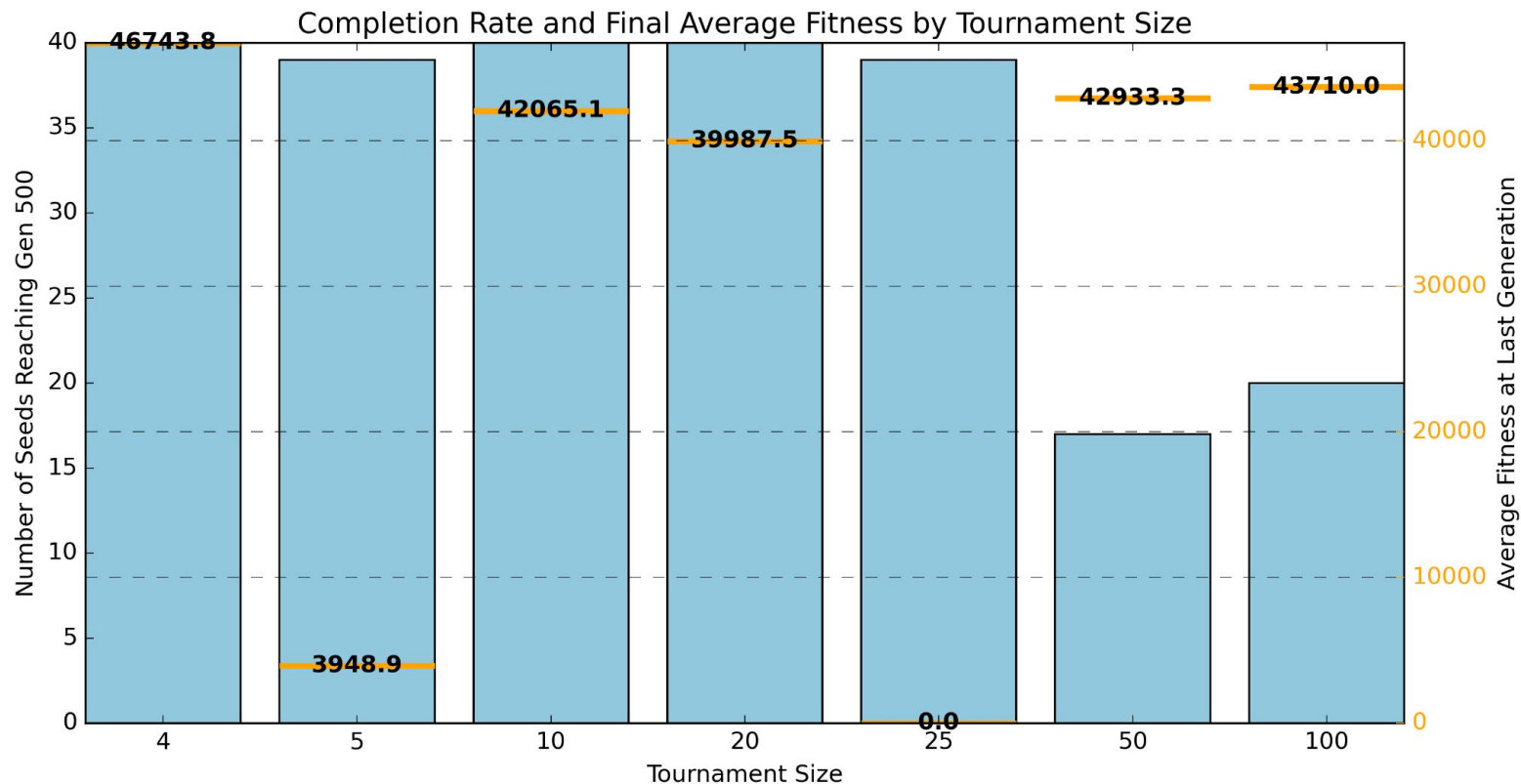


Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness

Research Question

Which selection methods and hyperparameter configuration maximizes the reduction in average population fitness over 500 generations compared to the initial method and parameters: tournament size 4 and mutation strength 0.25?

Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness : Tournament



Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness: Strategy

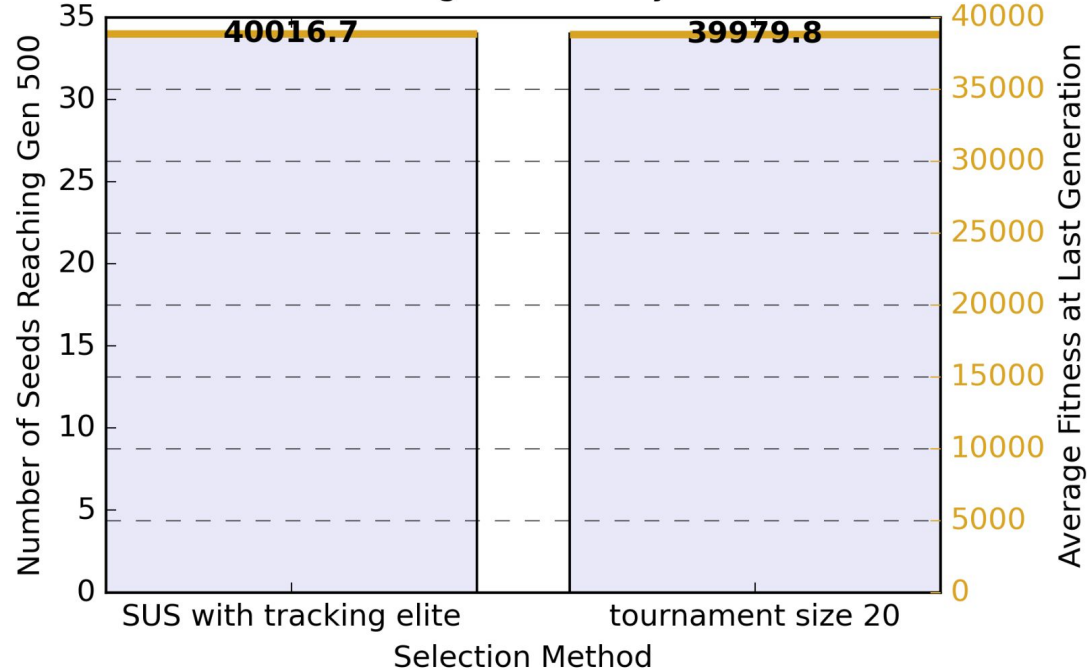
tournament size 20 -> truncation

challenge: proportionate selection -> Stochastic Uniform Sampling (SUS)

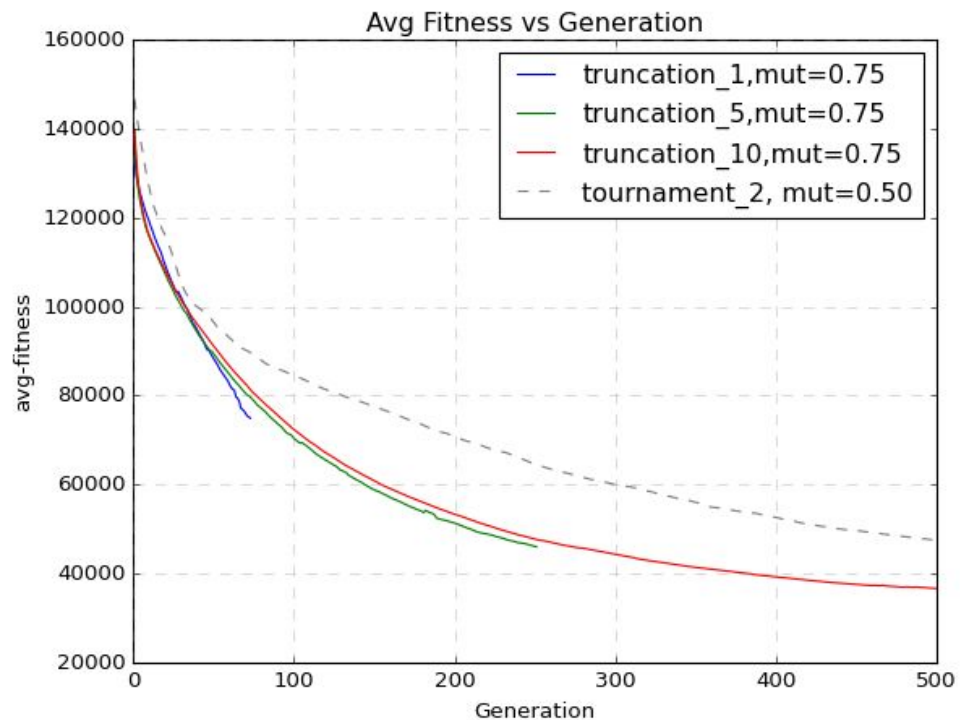
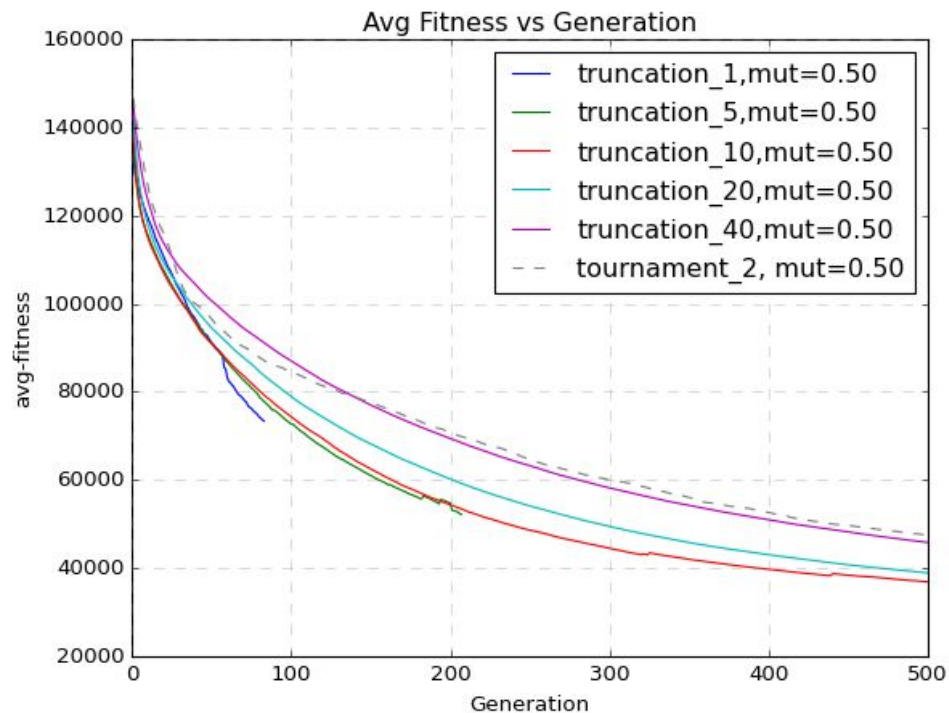
Elitism!

Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness : Tournament and SUS

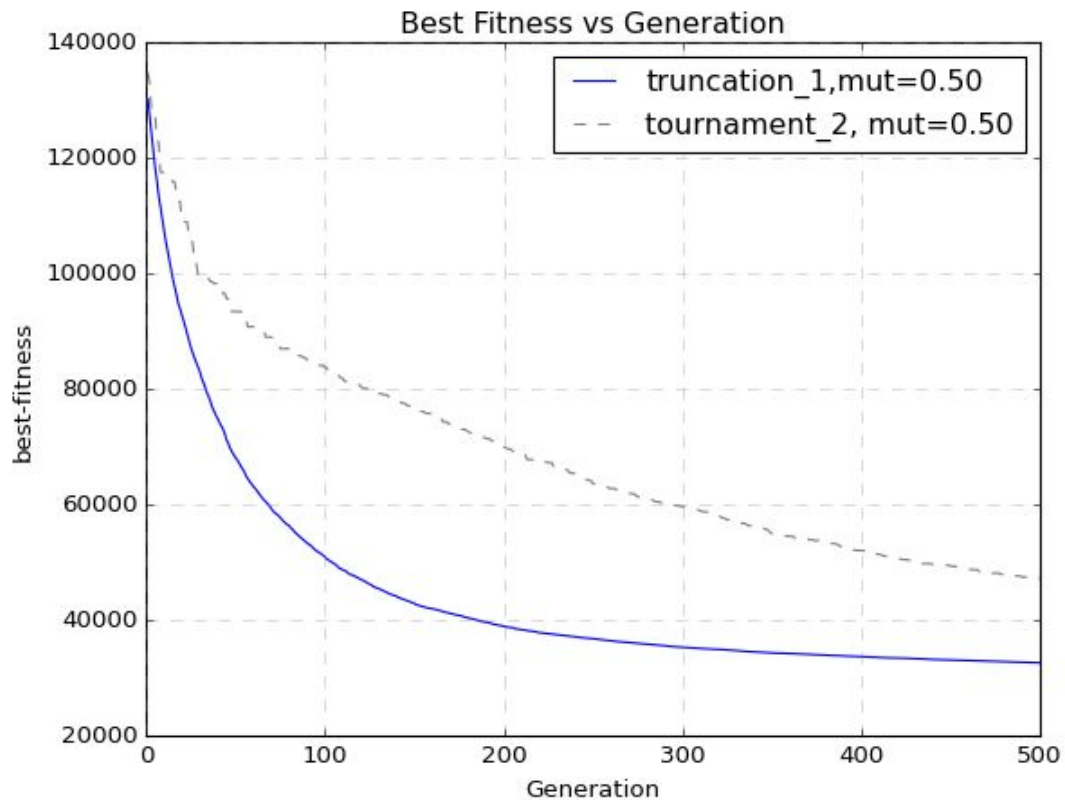
Completion Rate and Final Average Fitness by Selection Method (34 seeds)



Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness : Truncation



Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness : SSGA



Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation

A single Voronoi diagram is represented as:

xyrgbxyrgbxyrgbxyrgbxyrgbxyrgb

What would a good schema look like?

How about: ★★★★★xy★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★?

And what about: ★★★★★xyrgb★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★★?

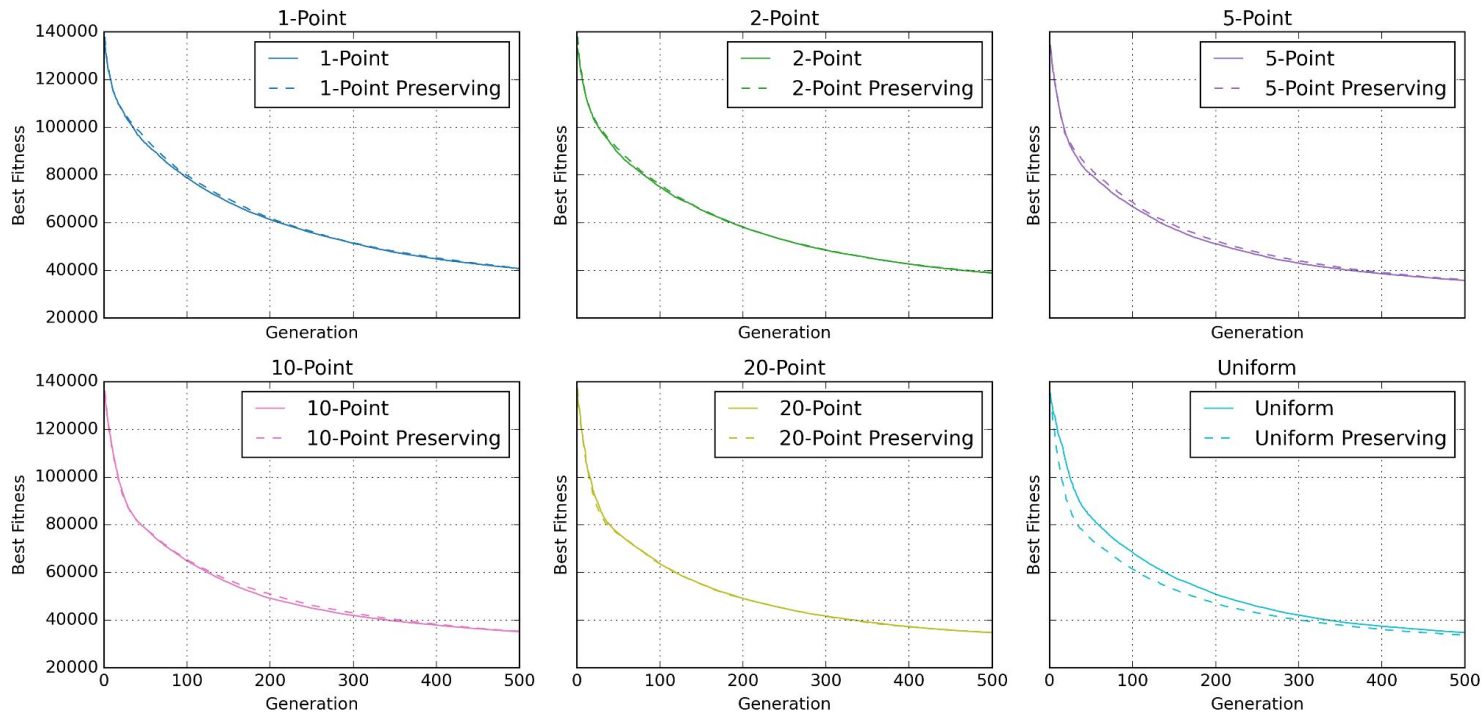
Or: ★★★★★xyrgbxyrgb★★★★★★xyrgb★★★★★?

Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation

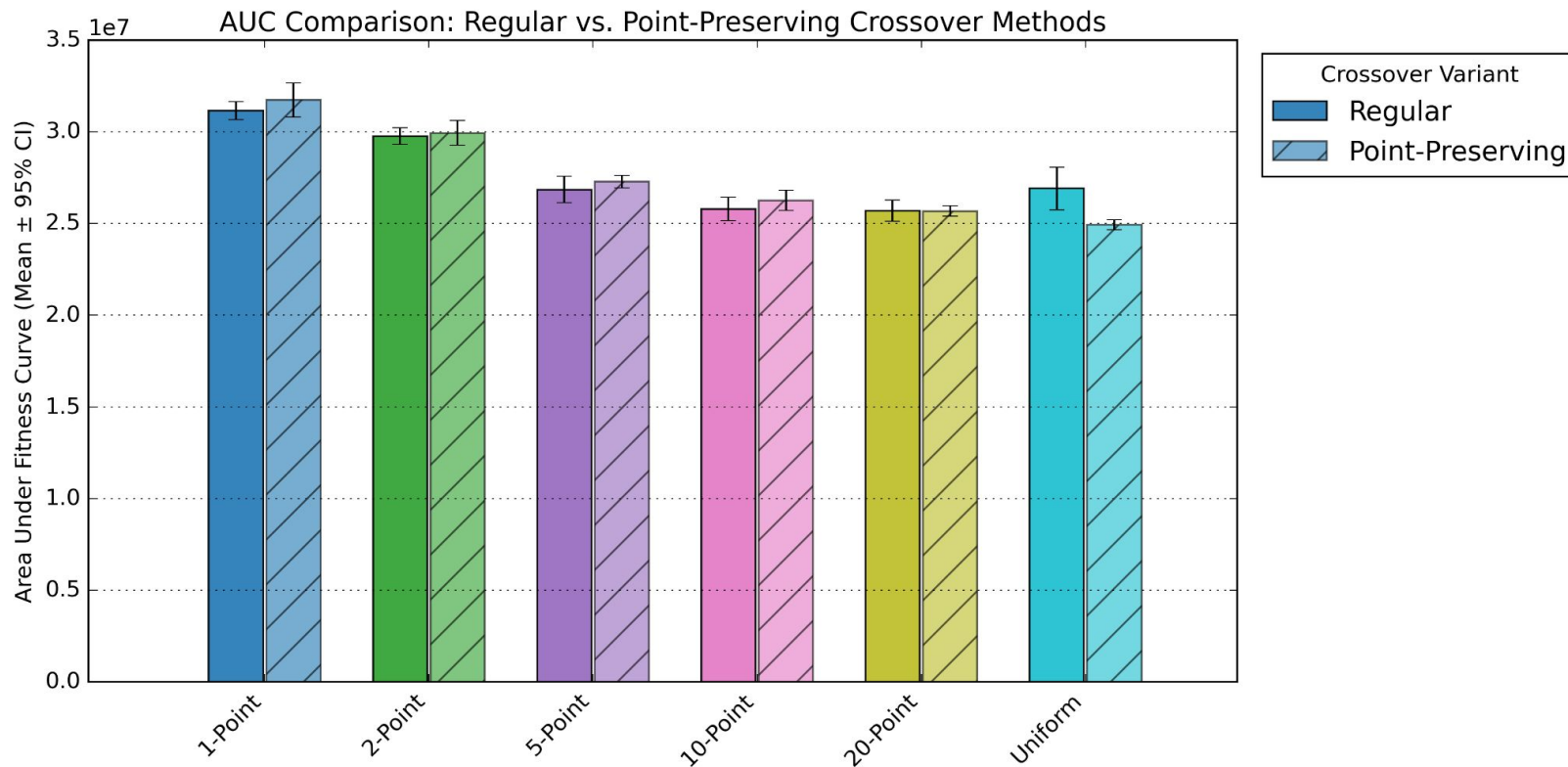
How does preserving the (x, y, r, g, b) -structure of individual Voronoi points during crossover affect the algorithm's convergence rate?

Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation

Regular vs. Point-Preserving Variants Across Crossover Methods



Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Results



Grey-box Initialization - Why?

Problem: Slow Convergence in Evolutionary Models

- The model takes a long time to converge
- It tries many random colors and positions.
- Final fitness after generations varies depending on the initial population.
- Results are inconsistent and unpredictable across runs.
- We suspect that better initialization could improve convergence and stability.

Grey-box Initialization - Using Domain Knowledge

Research question: To what extent does initializing the population using points extracted from reference image improve convergence speed and solution quality compared to random initialization?

Experiments:

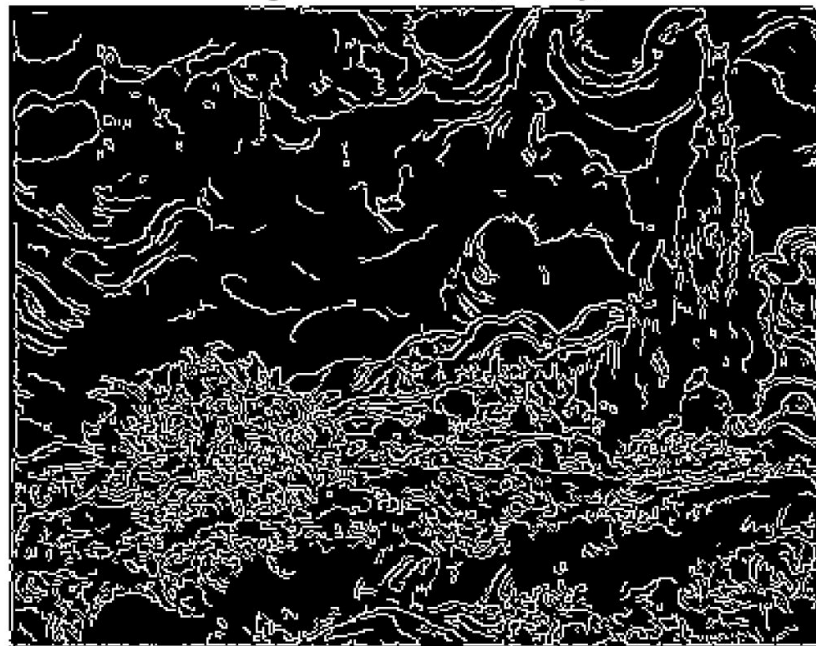
- **Edge-Based Initialization:** Places more points in regions with high color variation (edges)
- **Region-Based Color Averaging:** Starts with average colors in local regions

Experiment - 1 Edge Based Initialization

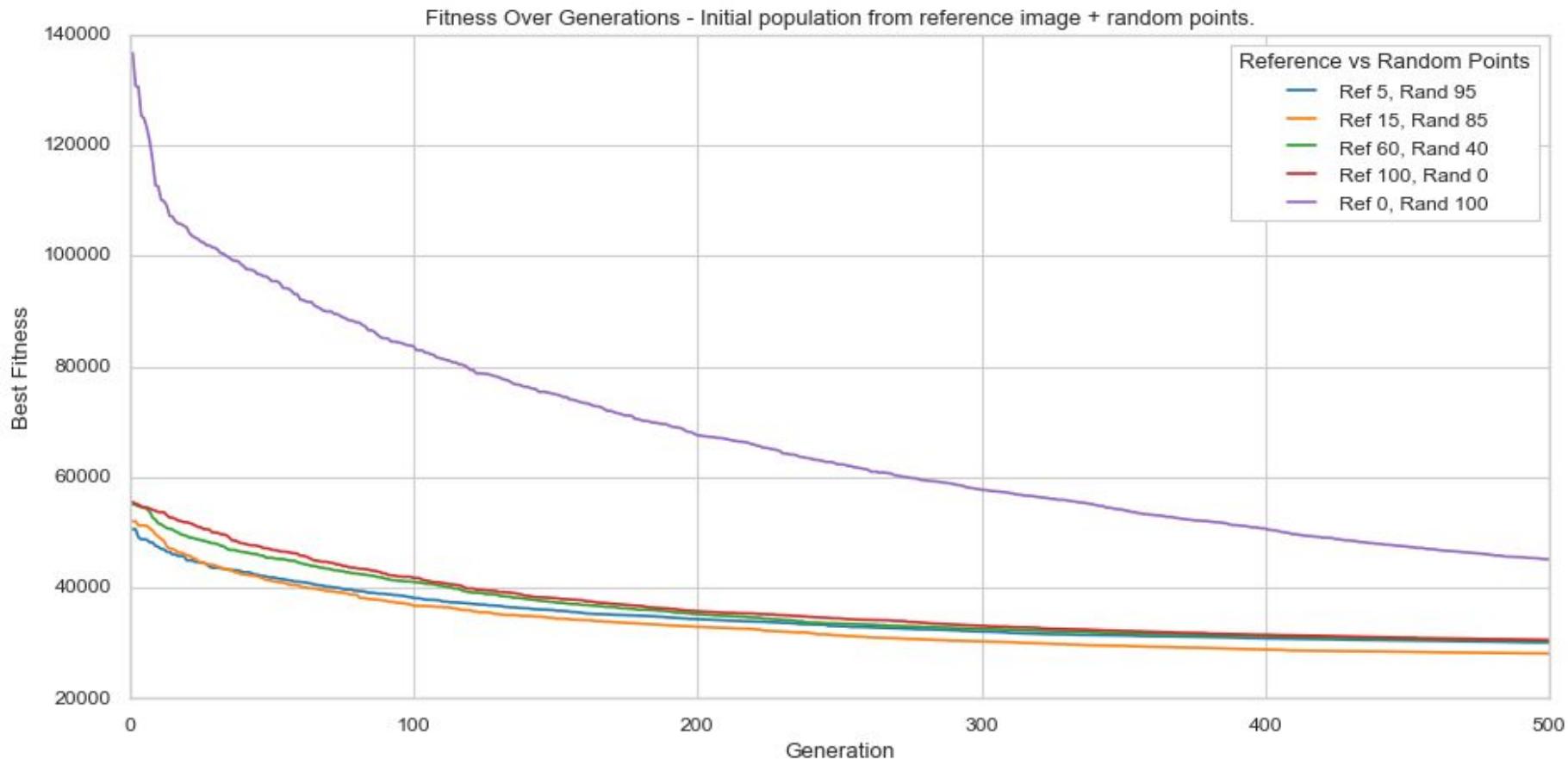
Resized Reference Image



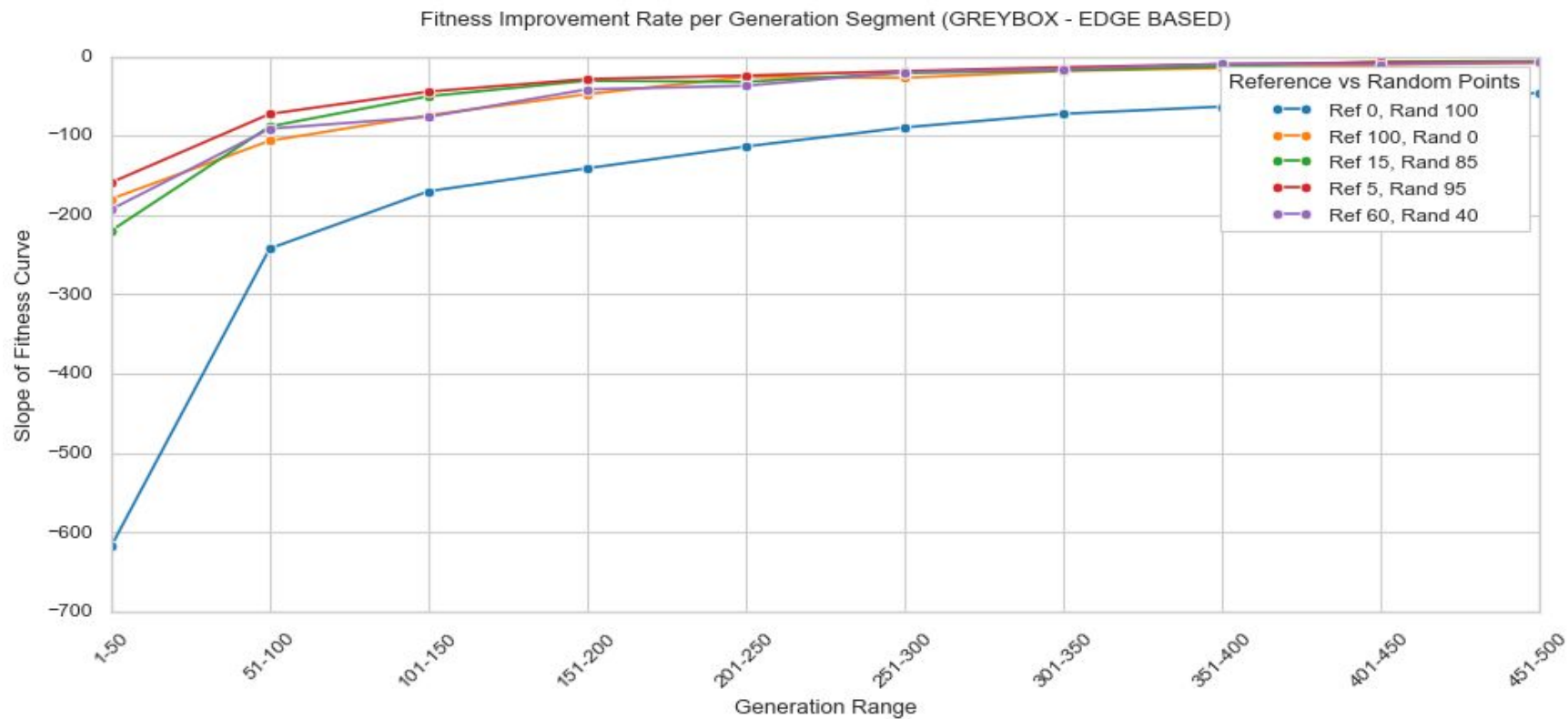
Edges Detected (Canny)



Edge-based initialization: Results



Edge-based initialization: Results



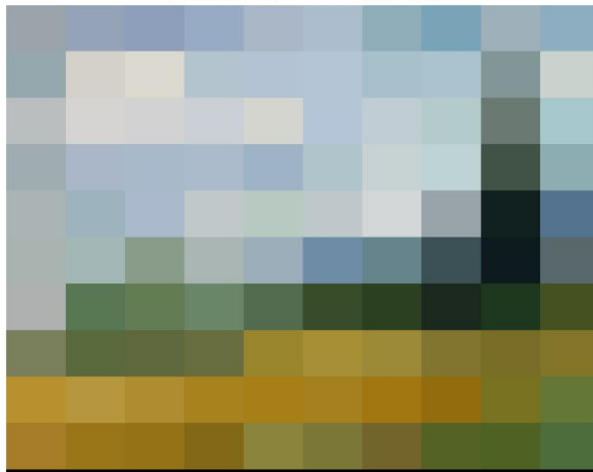
Experiment 2: regions-based

- Captures the image's overall tone

Step 1: Divide into Regions



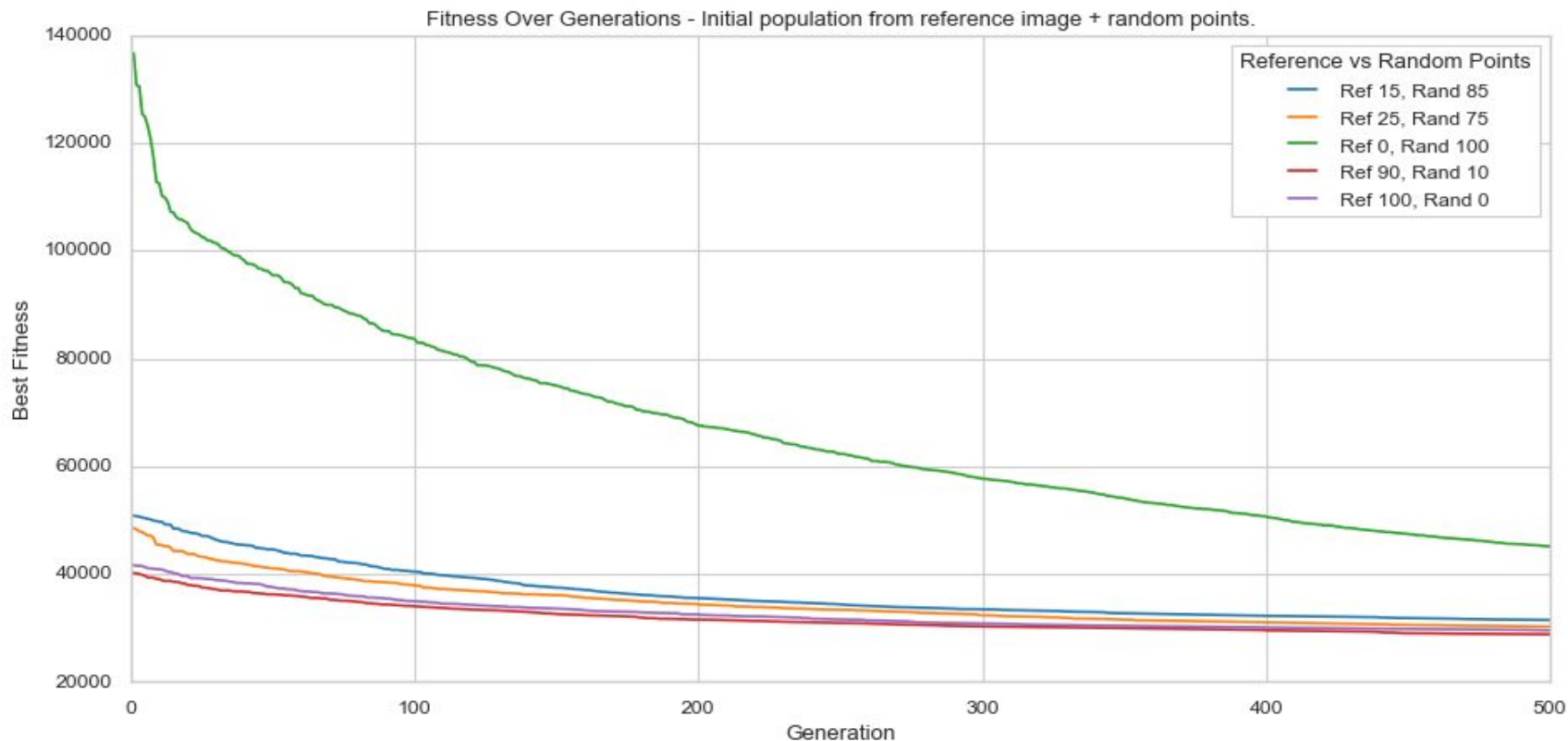
Step 2: Average Color per Region



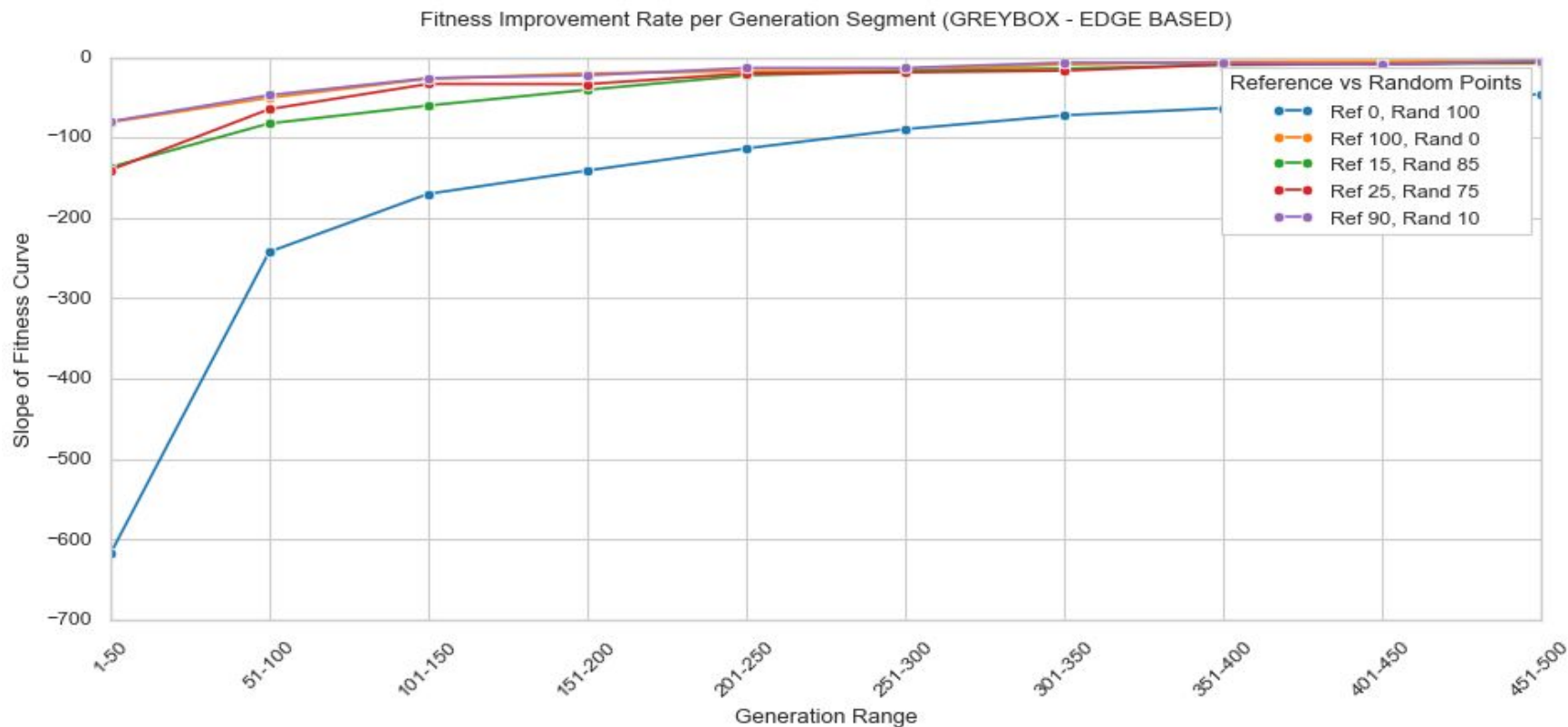
Step 3: Initial Points from Region Centers



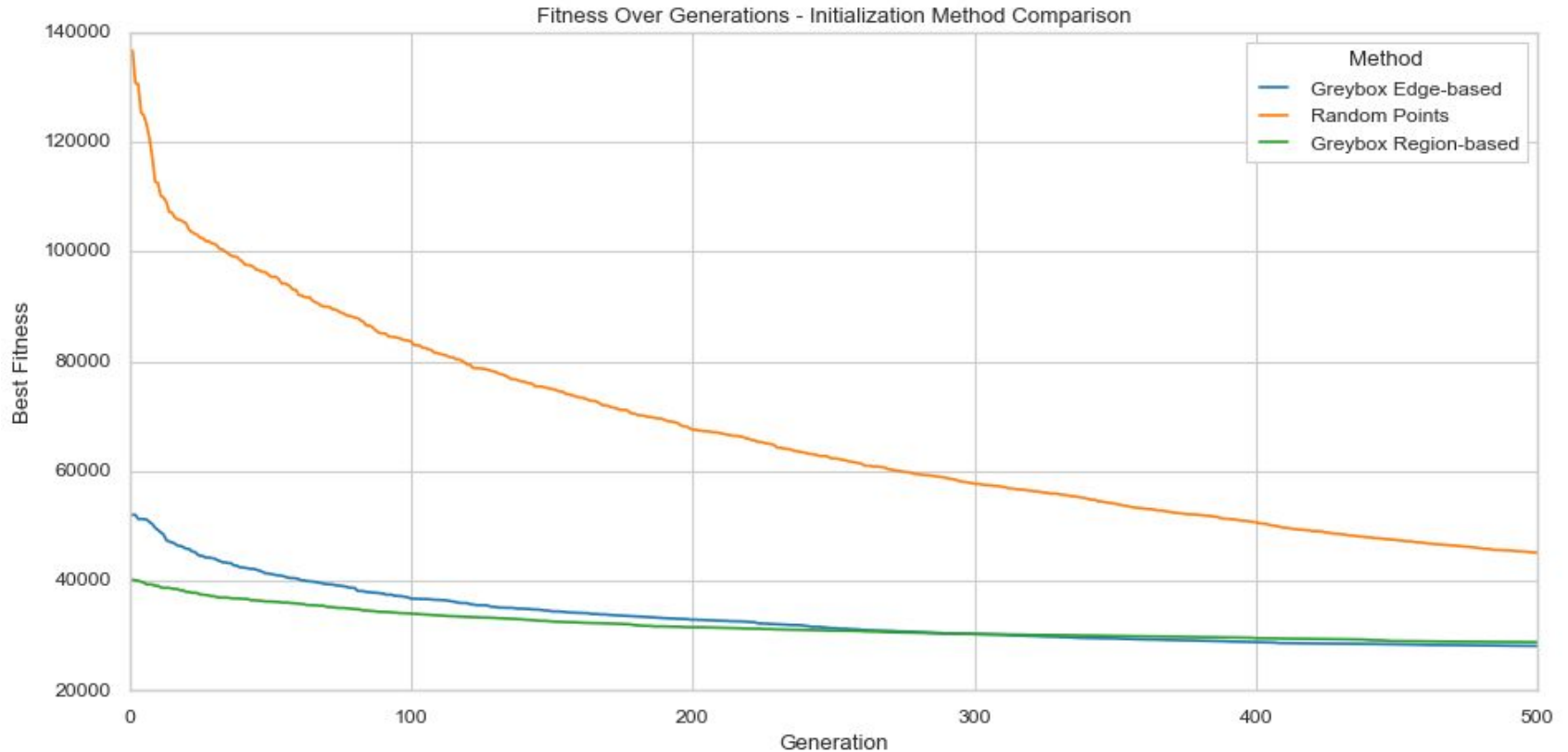
Region-based initialization: Results



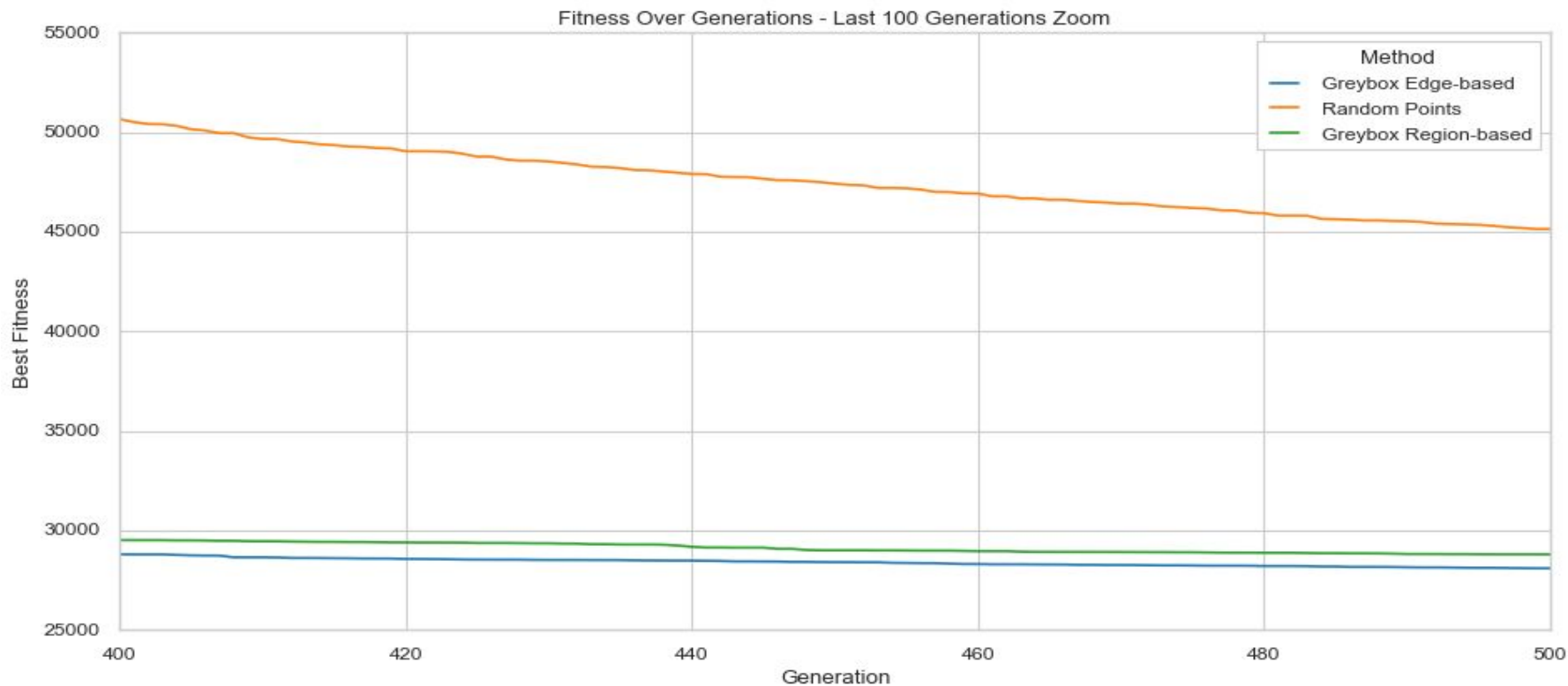
Region-based initialization: Results



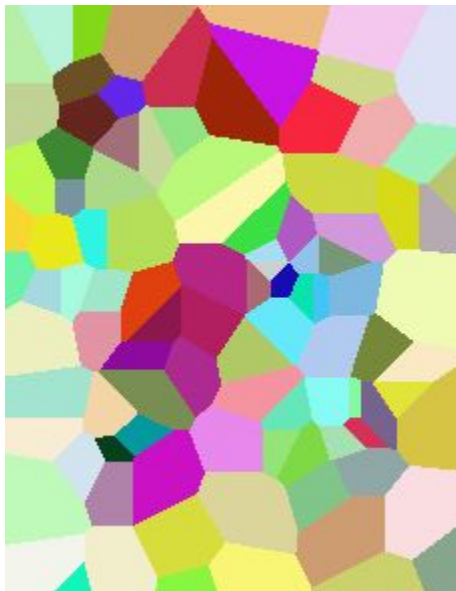
A comparison of the best fitnesses



Last 100 generations



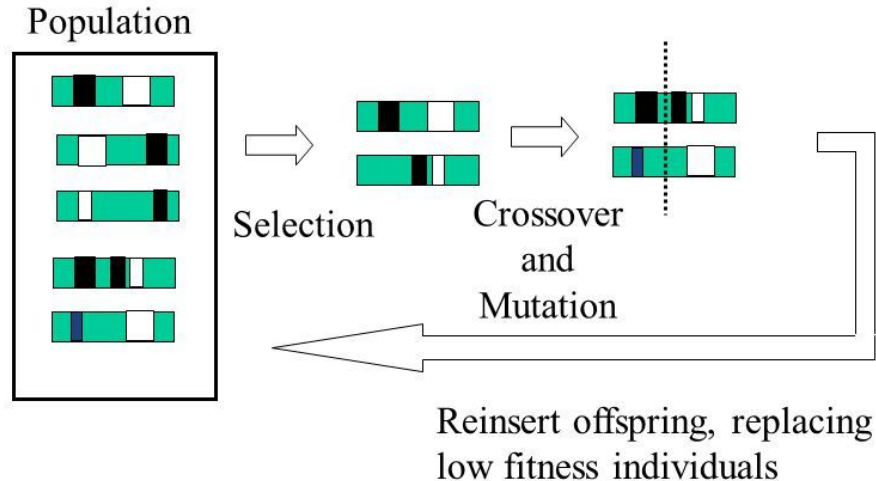
Questions?



Extra slides

Selection Methods to improve avg-fitness : SSGA

Steady-State Algorithm



Distribution of work

Roxana	Grey-box Initialization: Region-based
Sanchita	Selection-truncation + SSGA
Sreevidya	Grey-box Initialization: Edge-based
Sofie	Selection-tournament + SUS
Tygo	Voronoi-preserving Crossover

Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Goal

Goal of variation: We want to combine good schema (building blocks) of well-performing parents to get even better offspring

Schema growth equation: Schema's with an above average fitness are expected to appear more often in the population when their probability of being disrupted is sufficiently low

Thus: Reducing the probability of disruption will encourage schemata with above average fitness

Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Idea

What does a building block in a Voronoi diagram look like?

Probably: a point or set of points that captures the image well

Because: A good schema is unlikely to contain only a part of a point, because the values (x, y, r, g, b) are dependent: it makes little sense for an “xy”-value to be good on its own. Instead: “Color rgb at xy is good” makes more sense

So: Keeping individual Voronoi points intact during crossover will reduce the probability of disruption

Let's design crossover operators that work on individual **points** rather than individual **integers**

Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Experiment

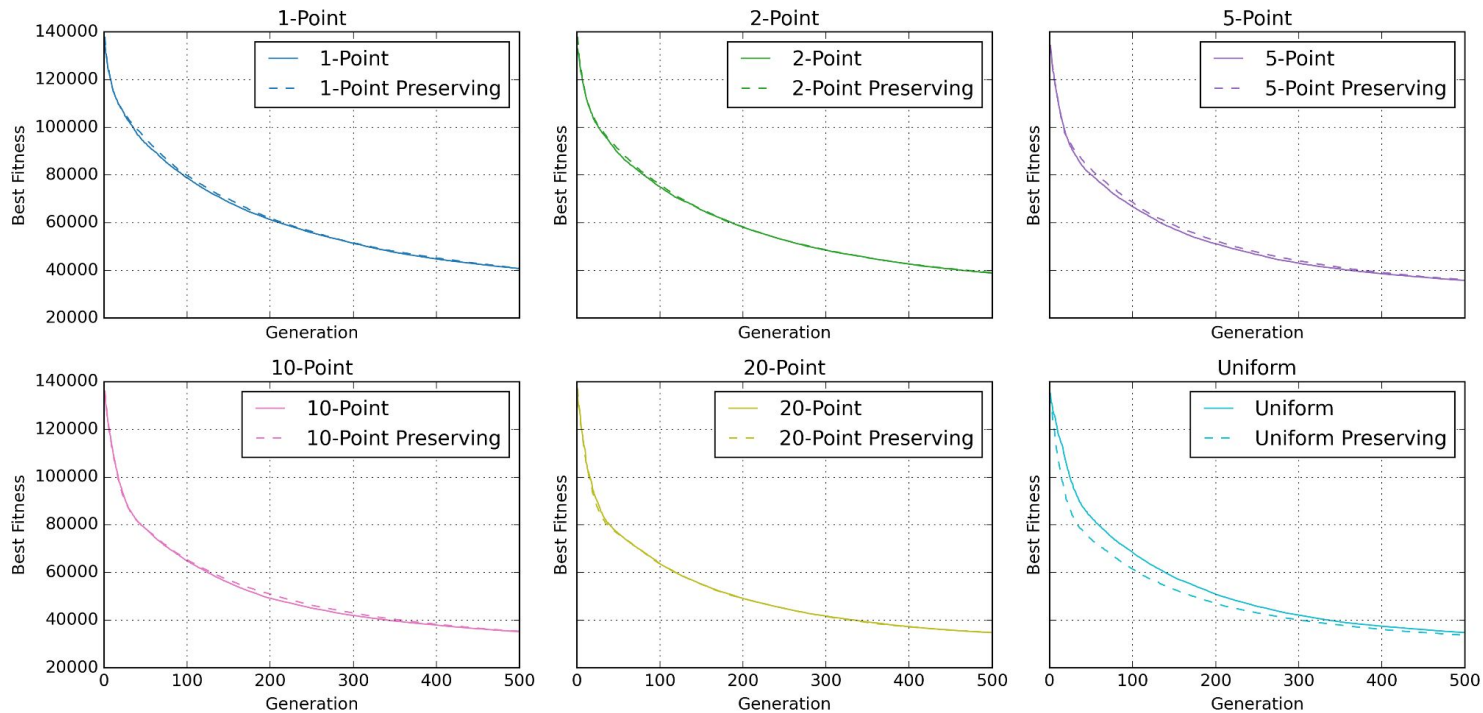
RQ: How does preserving the (x, y, r, g, b) -structure of individual Voronoi points during crossover affect the algorithm's convergence rate?

To find out, we take several common crossover-operators and implement a version that works on integers and one version that works on points

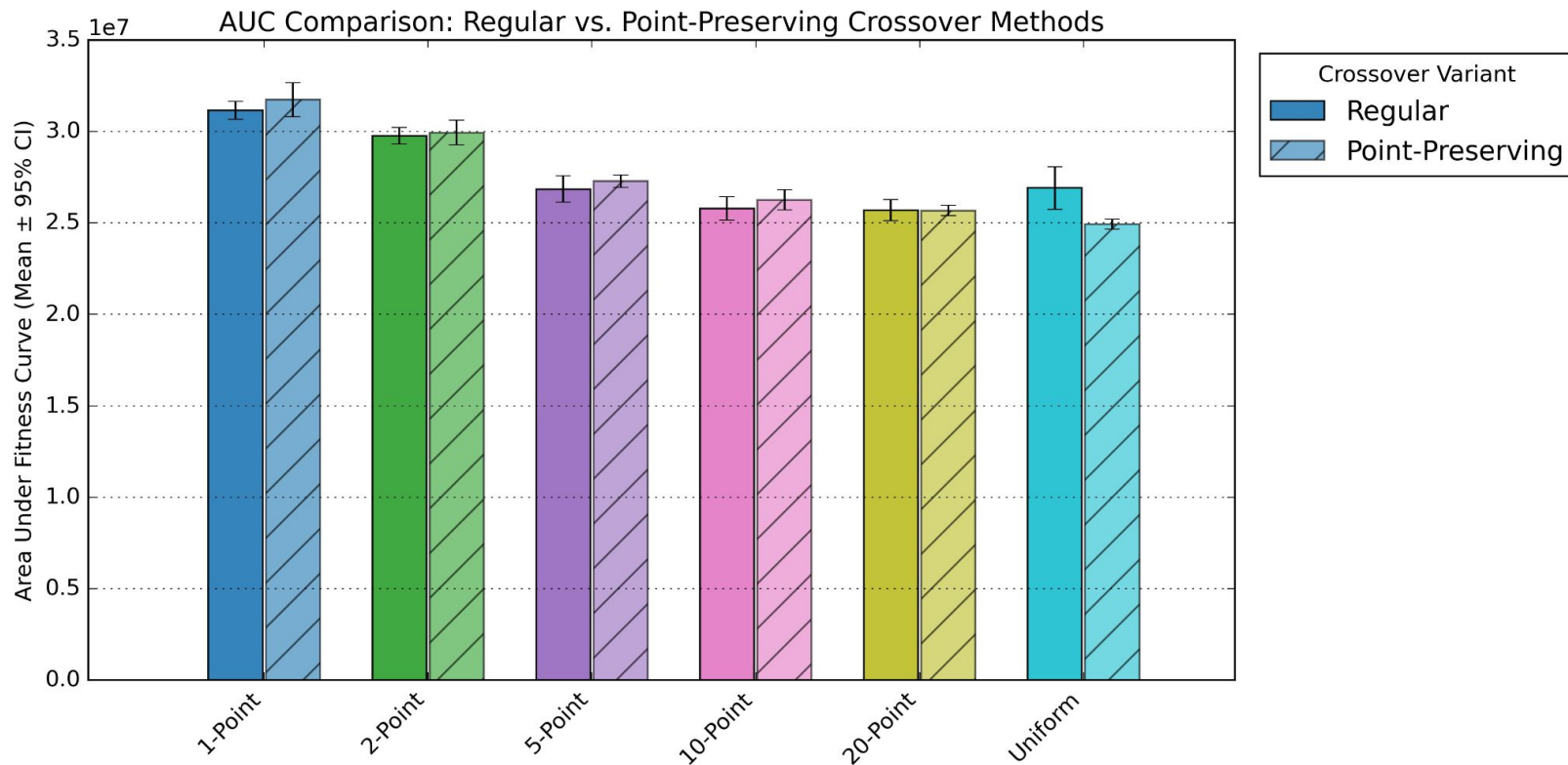
Then, we measure the best fitness over generations per operator, and we compare the point-based operators to their integer-based counterparts

Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Results

Regular vs. Point-Preserving Variants Across Crossover Methods



Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Results



Preserving Voronoi-points during Variation: Conclusion

Point-preserving crossover does not improve n-point crossover for $n \leq 20$

Point-preserving uniform crossover seems to perform the best

Possible reasons:

- n-point crossover already does not disrupt blocks that much (for low n)

- point-preserving crossover might not introduce enough variation

Tournament sizes

